

Introduction

CS 350

Dr. Joseph Eremondi

Last updated: January 6, 2025

Course Details

Course Objectives

To learn:

- Functional programming

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 - Recursion

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 - Parsing/Abstract Syntax

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 - Desugaring

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 - Desugaring
 - Evaluation

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 - Desugaring
 - Evaluation

To change how you *think* about programming

- Course Notes: *Functional Languages, Interpreters and Types*

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 - We'll follow loosely

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 - Announcements

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 - Assignments and Handin

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 - EXCEPTION: when you can't ask your question without revealing your solution to the assignment

- Location: RIC 317

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 - Take the elevator, go across the bridge and through the door

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Grading Scheme

- 35% assignments

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- 15% midterm

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 - In-class

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 - Wednesday, Feb 12

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- 40% final

Grading Scheme

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- 15% midterm
 - In-class
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- 40% final
- 10% Participation

- You get marks just for showing up

Participation

- You get marks just for showing up
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- Assignment 0 is 1% (counts as 2 lectures)

Assignment 0

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CS350 Handin



Assignments 1-6

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 - Last two are “optional” if you’re happy with your marks

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 - Sample based marking

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- After a submission, you get:
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- **READ THE TEST RESULTS** to know what you need to fix

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- It's better to submit code that fails some tests than to submit code with type or syntax errors

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- There are many languages built using Racket
 - Copying code will probably get you a 0

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Don't set yourself up for failure on the exams

Course Content

Course Objectives

Programming language genealogy and design.

Imperative, functional, and object-oriented language paradigms.

Context-free grammars and syntax trees.

Data types, control structures, exception handling, data abstraction, information hiding, and non-determinism.

Program representation, translation, and execution.

Functional programming: advantages, constructs, closures, and higher-order operations.

Parallel programming.

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- *First half of the class: Programming in Flit*

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- *Second half of class: implementing interpreters*

Common Questions

- Am I going to use Racket in Industry?

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 - No

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 - Then you'll be able to learn whatever language you need in industry

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 - The language we're learning is small (really just functions and pattern matching)

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 - But I can teach you what they're made of

- How to think about programs in a rigorous way

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 - Programs as mathematical objects

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 - Equations with programs

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 - Using types to communicate properties of code
- This is radically different from the kind of coding you have done so far